Nicole (Nicky) I. **Wakim**

Assistant Professor of Biostatistics · Oregon Health & Science University
1810 SW 5th Ave, Portland, OR 97201
wakim@ohsu.edu | nwakim.github.io | nwakim

Education

University of Michigan (UM) — Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. in Biostatistics — 2018 - 2023

University of Michigan (UM) — Ann Arbor, MI
M.S. in Biostatistics — 2016 - 2018

University of Virginia (UVA) — Charlottesville, VA
B.S. in Biomedical Engineering — 2012 - 2016

Areas of Scholarly Interest

- **Equity-centered trauma-informed pedagogy in statistics education:** researching, writing, disseminating on ways professors can improve inclusivity in their courses
- **Design and analysis of pragmatic trials:** designing studies and analysis plans for clinical trial interventions in real-world settings

Professional Experience

2023 - Present — **Assistant Professor of Biostatistics**
Oregon Health & Science University, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health

2022 - 2023 — **Graduate Student Research Assistant**
University of Michigan, Biostatistics Consulting Core
Advisor: Dr. Hui Jiang

2016 - 2021 — **Graduate Student Research Assistant**
University of Michigan, Alzheimer's Disease Center
Advisors: Dr. Zhenke Wu, Dr. Thomas Braun, Dr. Hiroko Dodge

2016 - 2018 — **Genome Science Training Program Trainee**
University of Michigan, Department of Biostatistics
Advisor: Dr. Hui Jiang

2014 - 2016 — **Research Assistant**
University of Virginia, Department of Biomedical Engineering
Advisors: Dr. Bijoy Kundu, Dr. Kimberly Kelly

Honors and Awards

2026 — **Educator Success Grant**, Oregon Health & Science University

2026	**Faculty of the Year Nomination**, Student Leadership Council, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2026	**Faculty Excellence Award in Teaching Nomination**, Student Leadership Council, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2025	**Transforming the Student Experience Award**, Teaching and Learning Center, Oregon Health & Science University
2025	**Faculty of the Year**, Student Leadership Council, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2023	**Educator Success Grant**, Oregon Health & Science University
2022	**Rackham Conference Travel Grant**, University of Michigan
2021	**Student Citizenship and Outreach Award Honorable Mention**, Department of Biostatistics, University of Michigan
2016 - 2018	**Genome Science Training Program (NHGRI T32)**, University of Michigan
2016	**Graduated with Highest Distinction (Summa Cum Laude)**, University of Virginia
2012 - 2016	**Dean's List (8 semesters)**, University of Virginia

Publications

Articles

1. **Wakim NI**, Braun TM, Kaye J, Dodge HH, for ORCATECH. "Choosing the right time granularity for analysis of digital biomarker trajectories." *Alzheimer's & Dementia: Translational Research & Clinical Interventions*, 2020.
2. Dodge HH, Goldstein FC, **Wakim NI**, et al.. "Differentiating among stages of cognitive impairment in aging: Version 3 of the Uniform Data Set (UDS) neuropsychological test battery and MoCA index scores." *Alzheimer's & Dementia: Translational Research & Clinical Interventions*, 2020.
3. Schnepp PM, Shelley G, Dai J, **Wakim NI**, Jiang H, Mizokami A, and Keller ET. "Single-Cell Transcriptomics Analysis Identifies Nuclear Protein 1 as a Regulator of Docetaxel Resistance in Prostate Cancer Cells." *Molecular Cancer Research*, 2020.
4. Marawar R, **Wakim NI**, Albin RL, and Dodge HH. "Seizure occurrence and related mortality in dementia with Lewy bodies." *Epilepsy & Behavior*, 2020.

Proceedings

1. **Wakim NI**. "Guidelines for a more inclusive statistics and data science classroom through trauma-informed pedagogy." *International Association for Statistical Education*, 2026.

Presentations

Oral

1. "Guidelines for a more inclusive statistics and data science classroom through trauma-informed pedagogy." *International Conference On Teaching Statistics*, 2026.
2. "Trauma-Informed Pedagogy in Statistics: Actionable Guidelines to Enhance Engagement and Learning." *Electronic Conference On Teaching Statistics*, 2026.

3. “Trauma-informed pedagogy in biostatistics: guidelines to improve student engagement and learning." *OHSU Symposium on Educational Excellence*, 2026.
4. “Analysis of Wearable Technology Devices Data." *Native American Research Centers for Health (NARCH) Training Grant Program*, 2025.
5. “Data equity in biostatistics education: development and dissemination of a new open-access teaching data resource." *OHSU Symposium on Educational Excellence*, 2024.
6. “Inclusive teaching in Statistics: development of a new open-access teaching data resource." *Electronic Conference On Teaching Statistics*, 2024.
7. “Inclusive teaching in biostatistics: development of a new open-access teaching data resource." *ASA Oregon Chapter Meeting*, 2024.
8. “Empowering Educators with DEIJ Datasets: A Journey of Transformation." *OHSU-PSU School of Public Health Faculty Spotlight Series*, 2023.
9. “Analysis of Wearable Technology Devices Data." *Native American Research Centers for Health (NARCH) Training Grant Program*, 2023.
10. “Imputing and Summarizing Multiple Correlated HighFrequency Digital Biomarkers." *Eastern North American Region International Biometric Society*, 2023.
11. “Implementing Different Imputation Pipelines for High-Frequency Digital Biomarkers with Missing Data and Lower-Frequency Binary Outcomes." *Joint Statistical Meetings*, 2022.
12. “Analysis and Summarization Pipeline for High frequency Predictors with Missing Data and Lower frequency Binary Outcomes." *Eastern North American Region International Biometric Society*, 2022.
13. “Journal Articles: How to search, read and organize them?." *Biostatistics Brown Bag Meetings*, 2021.
14. “Race/Ethnicity and Statistical Genetics." *UM Biostatistics DEI Journal Club*, 2021.
15. “Hot deck imputation for accelerometer data." *Michigan Statistics for Individualized-healthcare Lab Meeting*, 2020.

Poster

1. “Community-engaged research partnerships for building capacity and training in inclusive data science." *OHSU Symposium on Educational Excellence*, 2024.
2. “Hourly, Daily, Weekly or Monthly? Choosing the right data granularity for analysis of digital biomarker trajectories." *Alzheimer's Association International Conference*, 2020.
3. “Choosing the right time granularity for analysis of digital biomarker trajectories." *Joint Statistical Meetings*, 2020.
4. “Novel Clustering Method to Handle Outliers in Single Cell RNA Sequencing Data." *NHGRI Research Training and Career Development Annual Meeting*, 2018.

Grants and Contracts

Active

2026 - Present **1UG3CA309489-01 (PI Davis)**
Role: Co-Investigator / Biostatistician
The BUNDLE study will adapt proven single-cancer outreach strategies into a multicomponent intervention targeting all USPSTF-recommended screenings (colorectal, breast, cervical, and lung), engaging 18+ primary care clinics and 1,600+ patients across Oregon and North Carolina. Using a six-year cluster randomized trial design, the study aims to achieve a 10% or greater increase in screening completion while evaluating cost-effectiveness and the multilevel factors that influence screening behavior.

2026 - Present **3OT2OD038368-01S1 (PI Davis)**
Role: Biostatistician
The PRaCTICe Network Research Hub partners with rural clinics across six Western states to support primary care research, education, and technical assistance. Through four cores, Community Engagement, Recruitment & Trials, Data Coordination, and Communications & Dissemination, it facilitates participant recruitment, codesigns studies, and strengthens rural research infrastructure. The network aims to enhance primary care engagement, implement research advances, and improve health outcomes in rural communities.

2025 - Present **5R01AG082931-02 (PI Dorr)**
Role: Biostatistician
The MC COMPARE project uses aggregated EHR data via the eCarePlan application to improve care for patients with multiple chronic conditions. It aims to quantify risks, support personalized decisions, and enhance clinical trial outcomes by harmonizing data from multiple sources and engaging patients and providers.

Completed

2024 - 2025 **1R25GM150166-01 (PI Marriott)**
Role: Biostatistician
This study explores factors associated with biomedical workforce professional development. It measures the development of STEM beliefs and psychosocial factors over time, including how courses, training experiences, and/or instructional practices influence decision-making and career trajectories. This study explores the representation of professional self in portfolio materials for diverse trainees and professionals.

Professional Service

Academic Service

2025 - Present ASA Section on Statistics and Data Science Education Mentoring Committee

2025 - Present American Statistical Association Oregon Chapter Treasurer

2026 Statistics Judge, Northwest Science Expo

2023 - 2025 American Statistical Association Representative for the Oregon Chapter

OHSU-PSU School of Public Health

2026	SPH Catalyst Awards Reviewer
2026 - Present	Biostatistics Admissions Committee
2025 - Present	Founder of Writing Group for Early Career Faculty
2025 - Present	Research Committee
2025 - Present	Hiring Committee for the Biostatistics and Design Program Student Internship
2024 - Present	Biostatistics Curriculum Committee
2024 - Present	Epidemiology Curriculum Committee
2023 - Present	Biostatistics Comprehensive Exam Committee
2023 - Present	Scholarship Review Committee
2025	Strategic Planning Committee
2025	Presentation Judge, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health Student Conference
2025	Biostatistics Representative at Admitted Students Night
2025	Attended Assistant Dean of Enrollment Management Job Talks
2024 - Present	Biostatistics Representative at Assessment Reporting Day
2023 - 2025	Student Affairs Committee

OHSU

2025	Faculty Senate Award Committee

PSU

2025	Panelist, STEM Day

Reviewing

2026	Wiley Publications Research Integrity
2026	International Conference on Teaching Statistics
2024 - 2025	Section on Statistics and Data Science Education Speed Presentation and Poster Competition, Joint Statistical Meetings
2024	Western North American Region (WNAR) Conference Student Paper Competition, International Biometric Society
2022	Undergraduate Class Project Competition (USCLAP)
2021	*Alzheimer's Research & Therapy*

University of Michigan

2018 - 2022	UM School of Public Health PhD Student Assembly (SPhD), President and Biostatistics Student Representative
2020 - 2022	UM Biostatistics Conflict Resolution Committee, Founder and President
2018 - 2022	STATCOM (Statistics in the Community), Member
2017 - 2022	UM Biostatistics Department Peer Mentoring Committee, Peer Mentor
2016 - 2022	UM Biostatistics Student Association, Member

Fall 2021	UM School of Public Health Discussion Panel: “Picture a Scientist”, Panel Question Developer
2020 - 2021	UM Biostatistics Student DEIJ Committee, Member
2019 - 2020	UM Biostatistics Admissions Committee, Student Representative
2019	UM Biostatistics First Year Retreat, Student Counselor
2017 - 2018	UM School of Public Health Student Assembly, Biostatistics Student Representative

Professional Memberships

2025 - Present	International Association for Statistical Education
2021 - Present	International Biometric Society
2020 - Present	Consortium for the Advancement of Undergraduate Statistics Education
2019 - Present	American Statistical Association
2025	Society for Clinical Trials
2020 - 2023	International Society to Advance Alzheimer's Research and Treatment

Teaching

Instruction

2026 - Present	**Instructor on Record**, Introduction to R, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2026	**Instructor on Record**, Introduction to Python for Health Data Science, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2024 - Present	**Instructor on Record**, Linear Models, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2023 - Present	**Instructor on Record**, Introduction to Probability, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2023 - Present	**Instructor on Record**, Categorical Data Analysis, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2025	**Instructor on Record**, Wearable Device Data, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2024 - 2025	**Instructor on Record**, Biostatistics 1, OHSU-PSU School of Public Health

Guest Lectures

2024 - Present	**Guest Lecturer** on Missing Data, Applied Biostatistics II, OHSU Humans Investigations Program
2020 - 2022	**Guest Lecturer** on Model Selection, Big Data Summer Institute, SIBS Program at the University of Michigan
2020 - 2022	**Guest Lecturer**, Theory and Application of Generalized Linear Models, University of Michigan

Assistantships

2025	**Teaching Assistant**, OCTRI BERD R/Quarto Workshop, OHSU
2021	**Graduate Student Instructor**, Applied Biostatistics, University of Michigan
2020 - 2021	**Graduate Student Instructor**, On-Job/On-Campus Master's in Clinical Research Design and Statistical Analysis, University of Michigan

2020 - 2021	**Statistics Tutor**, Theory and Application of Linear Regression, University of Michigan
2019 - 2021	**Statistics Tutor**, On-Job/On-Campus Master's in Clinical Research Design and Statistical Analysis, University of Michigan
2021	**Study Group Facilitator**, Theory and Application of Generalized Linear Models, University of Michigan
2020	**Study Group Facilitator**, Theory and Application of Linear Regression, University of Michigan
2015 - 2016	**Teaching Assistant**, Systems and Signals, University of Virginia
2014 - 2015	**Teaching Assistant**, Biomechanics, University of Virginia

Mentorship

Grant Study Design & Analysis Mentor

2026 — PI: Emily Ho
Grant title: Sulforaphane Supplementation to Support Resilience to Wildfire Smoke Exposure: Impacts on Detoxification, Microbiome, Cognition, and Whole Person Health

Dissertation Committees

2025 - 2026 — Madysen Schreiber, PhD
Dissertation: Malaria during pregnancy: Patterns, drivers, and effects of treatment-seeking behaviors among pregnant women of Bioko Island in Equatorial Guinea
Role: Committee Member

Practice Experience Study Design & Analysis Mentor

2026 — Sophia Mann, MPH
Project: An analysis of long-term immunity following yellow fever vaccination

2026 — Ashlyn Bailey, MPH
Project: OHSU-PSU School of Public Health Annual Student Survey: An Equity-Focused Analysis on Student Satisfaction

2026 — Théo Caldwell, MPH
Project: Exploring Virus-Specific Antibody Decay: The Yellow Fever–Measles Neutralizing Antibody Index Over Time

2025 — Hunter Ladd, MPH
Project: Finding Home Again

Study Design & Analysis Mentor

2026 - Present — Jared Cloutier, MPH, Gabriella Macera, MPH, Alexa Stefanko, MPH
Project: Are Comorbidities Associated with How Americans Get Primary Care? A Cross-sectional study with NHANES 2021-2023

2024 - 2025	Shabir Sarwary, MPH **Dissertation:** Association Between Region of Birth and Risk of Poor Cardiovascular Health: Findings from the National Health Interview Survey (2014-2018)
2024	Ariel Weingarten, MS **Project:** Nonparametric analysis of continuous outcomes

Miscellaneous Mentorship

2025	Charles Parker, MS Career and Ph.D. planning
2025	Sheetal Akula, MPH Career and program planning
2025	Mickey (Amy) McVeety, MPH, Vincenzo Cornacchione, MPH Assisted with EPI 536 TA work
2025	Vero Underwood Carrasco, MPH, Emma Leary, MPH, Emily Winters, MPH Career planning and help with EPI 536 work
2024	Tia Vafeas, MPH Career planning

Additional Training

2024 - Present	**Grant Writing Village** OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2024	**Foundations of Data Equity** We All Count
2024	**Data Equity Primer Workshop** We All Count
2024	**Progressive Pedagogy Workshop** OHSU-PSU School of Public Health
2023	**Faculty Success Program** National Center for Faculty Development and Diversity
2023	**Assessment Academy Book Club** Teaching and Learning Center Assessment Academy, Oregon Health & Science University
2022	**Preparing for Careers in Teaching Statistics and Data Science** Section on Statistics and Data Science Education, American Statistical Association
2022	**Preparing Future Faculty Program** Center for Research on Learning and Teaching, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
2022	**Pedagogical Methods for Biostatistics Course** University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
2021-2024	**Mentoring Program: Section on Statistics and Data Science Education** American Statistical Association

2021	**Diversity and Inclusive Teaching (DIT) Workshops** University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
2020-2021	**UM Graduate Teacher Certificate** University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
2020-2021	**Rackham Professional Development Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Certificate** University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
2020	**Electronic Conference on Teaching Statistics (eCOTS) Preparing to Teach Workshop** Virtual Conference